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# Syllabus for Introduction to Biology

## Credits: 3
## BIOL 1301

### *Instructor Contact Information:*

You can always send your instructor a private message through the Brightspace Messaging system, accessible via the envelope (Messages) icon in the top navigation bar. Once logged into your course, click your instructor's profile page to see all the ways you can communicate with them, including their email address.

### *Course Description*

The study of biology is essential to understand the principles that govern living organisms and how they interact with the environment. In this class, students are introduced to fundamental biological concepts, focusing on the scientific method and its application to studying life. Students will define biology and explore its role in understanding the natural world, investigate the different levels of biological organization, and examine cellular organization, structure, function, metabolism, and division. Special attention is given to ecological principles and their relevance to biological science, as well as evolution in the context of populations.

### *Learning Objectives*

Program Learning Outcomes (PLOs):

PLO1. Students will be able to describe the methods of inquiry that lead to scientific reasoning.
PLO2. Students will be able to recognize the foundation of the physical and life sciences and their applications.

Course Learning Outcomes (CLOs):

CLO1. Explain the scientific method and how it is used to study biology. (PLO1)
CLO2. Define biology and how it contributes to understanding the natural world. (PLO2)
CLO3. Compare and contrast the different levels of biological organization.
CLO4. Describe the basis for life using cellular organization, structure, function, metabolism, and division.
CLO5. Identify ecological principles in the context of biological science.
CLO6. Discuss evolution as it applies to populations.

### *Co/Prerequisites*

None.

### *Course Materials*

UoPeople courses use open educational resources (OER), and other materials specifically donated to the University with free permissions for educational use. Therefore, students are not required to purchase any textbooks or sign up for any websites that have a cost associated with them. The main required textbook for this course is listed below and can be readily accessed using the provided link. Additional learning

resources will also be provided in the course Learning Guide for each week to supplement your understanding of the material.

**Main Textbook:**

- Clark, M. A., Choi, J., & Douglas, M. (2020). *Biology 2e.* OpenStax. Licensed under CC 4.0.

## *Technology Requirements*

To fully engage in this course and make the most of your learning,

- **PC Required**: A PC is recommended to ensure full compatibility with course tools and activities.
- **Internet Connection**: A stable internet connection is advised for seamless access to course materials and activities.
- **Browser**: For optimal performance and compatibility with course tools, please use an up-to-date browser.

Students must also have the ability to save documents and files. Typically, University of the People learning materials are provided to students in either Adobe PDF or Microsoft Office compatible formats. Therefore, students need to be able to open and save documents in these formats as well.

### Campus Tech Support

Please contact your Program Advisor, who is your primary point of support throughout your studies.

#### *How to Contact Your Advisor*

If you are unsure who your Program Advisor is, or if you need additional assistance, you may also contact the Program Advising team at advising@uopeople.edu.

### Exam Technical Requirements & Support

To ensure maximum compatibility and reliability, it is highly recommended that you use the most recent version of Google Chrome or Mozilla Firefox when taking your exam. Furthermore, you should test the computer and browser ahead of time and ensure it has no technical issues that might hinder you during the exam period.

If you experience a technical problem during the exam, please contact your program advisor immediately.

## *Regular and Substantive Interaction*

As your instructor, they will interact and engage with each of you on a regular basis throughout the term to support your learning. They will provide direct instruction related to the course's learning objectives, respond to your questions, grade and/or provide feedback on your submitted coursework, post regular announcements, and engage in the course discussion areas regarding academic course content when appropriate.

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## *Course Expectations and Learning Activities*

### Discussions

Some units in this course require that you complete a Discussion Assignment. You are required to develop and post a substantive response to the Discussion Assignment in the Discussion Forum. A substantive response is one that fully answers the question that has been posed by the instructor. In addition, you must extend the discussion by responding to at least two (2) of your peers' postings in the Discussion Forum. Grading rubrics are provided in the Discussion Forum for each week. Discussion Forums are only active for each current and relevant learning week, so it is not possible to contribute to the forum once the learning week has come to an end.

### Assignments Activities

The assignment activities are graded by your instructor. The grading rubric is listed under the assignment instructions. The grading rubric is a document that outlines the criteria that your instructor will use to grade your work. Assignment activities can range from written assignments, infographics, to presentation videos. Failure to submit Assignment Activities may result in failure of the course.

### Quizzes

This course will contain two types of quiz – Self Quiz and a Graded Quiz. These quizzes may contain multiple-choice or true/false questions.

The results of the Self-Quiz will not count towards your final grade. However, it is highly recommended that you complete the Self-Quiz to ensure that you have adequately understood the course materials. Along with the Reading Assignments, the results of the Self-Quiz should be used as part of an iterative learning process, to thoroughly cover and test your understanding of course material.

On the other hand, the results of the Graded Quiz will count towards your final grade. Specific instructions on the format and content of the Graded Quiz will be provided by your instructor.

### Final Exam

The Final Exam will be available from Thursday through Sunday of Week/Unit 9, following the completion of eight units of work. The format of the Final Exam is similar to that of the quizzes and may contain a combination of different question types. You will have one attempt to take the exam, and it will be graded electronically. Specific instructions on how to prepare for and take the Final Exam will be provided during Week 8 (located inside the Unit 9 Learning Guide). Final Exams must be taken without the use of course learning materials (both those inside and outside the course). If particular materials are allowed for use during the exam, these will be noted in the exam's instructions.

### Course Forum

The Course Forum is the place to raise issues and questions relating to the course. It is regularly monitored by the instructors and is a good place to meet fellow students taking the same course. While it is not required to participate in the Course Forum, it is highly recommended.

### Class Introductions

This section is your opportunity to introduce yourself to your classmates and create a vibrant learning community. By sharing your background, interests, and goals, you can create meaningful connections and discover commonalities with your peers.

## *Participation Expectations*

To succeed in this course, you are expected to actively engage and participate regularly. Below are specific guidelines to help you meet these expectations:

- Be involved and active in your courses.
- Be highly motivated and disciplined.
- Check the course homepage, calendar and assignment page, the course syllabus, your UoPeople email, and the Moodle course discussion forums several times a week.
- Post the required comments and responses to the discussion forum for your course.
- Keep up with your assignments and online quizzes/exams (as applicable) and manage your time well. These quizzes test your knowledge and comprehension of the new content.
- Participate actively in class discussions.
- Be polite and respectful.
- Use good grammar and correct spelling.
- Be honest and original. Plagiarism will not be tolerated in any online course.

Non-participation is characterized by lack of any assignment submissions, inadequate contributions to the Discussion Forums, and/or lack of peer feedback to Discussion/Written Assignments. Also, please note the following important points about course participation:

- Assignments must be submitted on or before the specified deadline. A course timeline is provided in the course schedule, and the instructor will specify deadlines for each assignment.
- Occasionally there may be a legitimate reason for submitting an assignment late. Most of the time, late assignments will not be accepted and there will be no make-up assignments.
- All students are obligated to inform their instructor in advance of any known absences which may result in their non-participation.

## *Feedback and Suggestions*

We value your input and would encourage you to complete the end of course survey to provide us with course feedback and suggestions, and report issues.

## *Evaluation and Grading Scale*

### Grading Weights:

| Category | % Of Grade | Grade Items (Learning Activities) | Associated Learning Objectives/Outcomes |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Discussion Forum** | 30% | 1. Unit 1 – Discussion Forum<br>2. Unit 2 – Discussion Forum<br>3. Unit 6 – Discussion Forum<br>4. Unit 8 – Discussion Forum | • Unit 1 – CLO2, CLO3<br>• Unit 2 – CLO4<br>• Unit 6 – CLO6<br>• Unit 8 – CLO2, CLO5 |
| **Assignment Activities** | 55% | 1. Unit 1 – Assignment Activity<br>2. Unit 3 – Assignment Activity<br>3. Unit 4 – Assignment Activity<br>4. Unit 5 – Assignment Activity | • Unit 1 – CLO1<br>• Unit 3 – CLO3, CLO4<br>• Unit 4 – CLO2, CLO4 |

| Category | % Of Grade | Grade Items (Learning Activities) | Associated Learning Objectives/Outcomes |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | 5. Unit 6 – Assignment Activity<br>6. Unit 7 – Assignment Activity | • Unit 5 – CLO2, CLO4<br>• Unit 6 – CLO6<br>• Unit 7 – CLO2, CLO5 |
| **Graded Quiz** | 5% | 1. Unit 4 – Graded Quiz | • Unit 4 – CLO1, CLO2, CLO3, CLO4 |
| **Final** | 10% | 1. Unit 9 – Final Exam | • Unit 9 – CLO1, CLO2, CLO3, CLO4, CLO5, CLO6 |
| **TOTAL** | **100%** | | |

### Grading Scale:

| Letter Grade | % Grade | Grade Points |
|---|---|---|
| A | 98%-100% | 4.00 |
| A | 93-97% | 4.00 |
| A- | 90%-92% | 3.67 |
| B+ | 88%-89% | 3.33 |
| B | 83%-87% | 3.00 |
| B- | 80%-82% | 2.67 |
| C+ | 78%-79% | 2.33 |
| C | 73%-77% | 2.00 |
| C- | 70%-72% | 1.67 |
| D+ | 68-69% | 1.33 |
| D | 63%-67% | 1.00 |
| D- | 60%-62% | 0.67 |
| F | <60 | 0.00 |
| W | N/A | N/A |

*Students may also be granted Withdrawal (W), if they withdraw from the course, or an Incomplete (I) should their circumstances permit. A student who feels they were graded unfairly, or who seeks to dispute a grade, may initiate a grade appeal process. Refer to University Policies for more information on withdrawals and appeals.*

## *Course Schedule*

### UNIT 1: Introduction to Scientific Inquiry and Biological Molecules (Week 1)

- Watch/Read due by the 3rd or 4th day of the week

- Discussion first response due by the 4th day of the week
- Discussion replies due by 7th day of the week
- Assignment Activity submission due by the 7th day of the week

**UNIT 2: Biological Molecules (Week 2)**

- Watch/Read due by the 3rd or 4th day of the week
- Discussion first response due by the 4th day of the week
- Discussion replies due by 7th day of the week

**UNIT 3: Energy and Metabolism in Cells (Week 3)**

- Watch/Read due by the 3rd or 4th day of the week
- Assignment Activity submission due by the 7th day of the week

**UNIT 4: Cell Division and Reproduction (Week 4)**

- Watch/Read due by the 3rd or 4th day of the week
- Assignment Activity submission due by the 7th day of the week
- Graded Quiz due by the 7th day of the week

**UNIT 5: Genetics and Inheritance (Week 5)**

- Watch/Read due by the 3rd or 4th day of the week
- Assignment Activity submission due by the 7th day of the week

**UNIT 6: Evolution and Natural Selection (Week 6)**

- Watch/Read due by the 3rd or 4th day of the week
- Discussion first response due by the 4th day of the week
- Discussion replies due by 7th day of the week
- Assignment Activity submission due by the 7th day of the week

**UNIT 7: Ecology and Interactions in Ecosystems (Week 7)**

- Watch/Read due by the 3rd or 4th day of the week
- Assignment Activity submission due by the 7th day of the week

**UNIT 8: The Future of Biology and Biotechnology (Week 8)**

- Watch/Read due by the 3rd or 4th day of the week
- Discussion first response due by the 4th day of the week
- Discussion replies due by 7th day of the week

**UNIT 9: Final Exam (Week 9)**

- Final Exam due by the 4th day of the week

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## *University Policies & Processes*

### Late Work/Make-up Policy

Please review the Late Work policy in the University Catalog.

### Code of Conduct

University of the People expects that students conduct themselves in a respectful, collaborative, and honest manner at all times. Harassment, threatening behavior, or deliberate embarrassment of others will not be permitted. Any conduct that interferes with the quality of the educational experience is not allowed and may result in disciplinary action, such as course failure, probation, suspension, or dismissal. For more information on this topic, please review the General Code of Conduct in the University Catalog.

### Procedures for Resolving Academic Grievances/Appeals

If you believe that the final grade you received for a course is erroneous, unjust, or unfair, please contact your course instructor. This must be done within seven days of the posted final grade. For more information on this topic, please review the Grievance Policy and Grade Appeals Procedure in the University Catalog.

### Withdrawal and Drop Date Policy

Please review the Course Drops and Withdrawals policy of the University Catalog.

### Academic Integrity and Plagiarism

Plagiarism is a serious breach of academic trust. In academic work, our words and ideas are the value of our work, so turning in someone else's work as if it were your own is a form of theft. When you use someone else's words and ideas--whether it's the work of a famous writer or a fellow student--without crediting the source or authorship of those words and ideas, you are plagiarizing.
**Please review the Code of Academic Integrity in the University catalog for more information.**

**Reference:** Lee, C. (2019, April 4). *How to address Academic Integrity in your course syllabus.* Turnitin. https://www.turnitin.com/blog/how-to-address-academic-integrity-in-your-course-syllabus

### Intellectual Property

UoPeople respects the intellectual property rights of others who seek to create, preserve, and disseminate knowledge through teaching, collective learning, and continued research at the University at large. For more information on this topic, please review the Intellectual Property policy in the University catalog.

### Reasonable Accommodations

Contact your Program Advisor to open a request for support.

## *Student Support Services & Resources*

### English Programs

Academic Advising: advising@uopeople.edu
Financial Aid: financial.aid@uopeople.edu
Library Resources: library@uopeople.edu
Payment Processing: payments@uopeople.edu




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Student Services: student.services@uopeople.edu
Technical Support: advising@uopeople.edu